

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1247

By Powell

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Lawrence Richard Ahern III of Nashville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Lawrence "Larry" Richard Ahern III; and

WHEREAS, Larry Ahern was an exemplary gentleman and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Kingsport, Lawrence Richard Ahern III was the son of Lawrence Richard Ahern, Jr., and Rhue Bagwell Ahern and graduated from Castle Heights Military Academy in Lebanon in 1965; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Ahern attended Vanderbilt University, where he was elected president of Pi Kappa Alpha fraternity and graduated with a bachelor's degree in 1969; he attended Vanderbilt Law School and received his law degree in 1972; and

WHEREAS, a military veteran, Larry Ahern was a member of the Army ROTC and enlisted in the United States Army, where he served with the Army reserves at the end of the Vietnam War; and

WHEREAS, a highly successful attorney, Larry Ahern practiced bankruptcy and commercial law in Chattanooga and Nashville for tenures at several prominent legal firms, namely, Miller & Martin; Bass, Berry & Sims; and Burr & Forman; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Ahern retired from "big firm" practice in 2013 and limited his practice to consulting engagements by legal and financial professionals, including expert testimony on legal issues involving bankruptcy, commercial law, and real estate law. In 2023, he took retired

partner status with Brown & Ahern, which has been designated as a Tier 1 Law Firm by *U.S. News* since 2016; and

WHEREAS, sharing his legal knowledge, he served as an Adjunct Professor of Law at Vanderbilt Law School, St. John's University Law School, and Belmont University College of Law and was a Visiting Professor at Cumberland School of Law; and

WHEREAS, a highly respected member of the legal profession, Larry Ahern was a Fellow of both the American College of Bankruptcy and the American College of Mortgage Attorneys, as well as a Distinguished Fellow of the Association of Insolvency and Restructuring Advisors (AIRA); he was certified as a Business Bankruptcy Specialist by the American Board of Certification (ABC) in 1994; and

WHEREAS, he chaired the ABC and the Tennessee Commission on CLE and Specialization and was a Director Emeritus of the ABC; additionally, he served on the Advisory Board of the St. John's Bankruptcy LL.M program and was a member of the American Bankruptcy Institute, the former Director of the AIRA, and a former Director and Chapter President of the Turnaround Management Association; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to awards and accolades, Mr. Ahern was listed in *The Best Lawyers in America*, starting in 1989, in the categories of business reorganization, creditors' rights, and bankruptcy litigation, and he was honored by various publications based on peer ratings such as "best of the bar" and similar honors; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Ahern was a frequent speaker and an author and co-author of numerous books and articles on bankruptcy, commercial and real estate law, and related fields; and

WHEREAS, an avid outdoorsman, Larry Ahern enjoyed outdoor sports with his family and friends, including hiking, rafting, whitewater kayaking, cycling, and skiing. He taught kayaking in Nashville and volunteered with Scouting America; and

WHEREAS, a devoted husband, father, and grandfather, Mr. Ahern enjoyed the loving companionship of his wife, Karen Cole Ahern, and was the proud father of Bonner Claire Ahern, Cole Benjamin Ahern, Elizabeth (Steve) Chatham, and Kirkland (Rob) Hendrickson, and doting grandfather of Catherine Chatham and John Chatham; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by his sister, Ann Ahern Allen, his in-laws, George and Cindy Cole, and Martin and Eve Cole, and several beloved nieces and nephews; and

WHEREAS, Larry Ahern leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional citizen and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Lawrence Richard Ahern III, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Ahern.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.